

CLIFFORD WARREN SMITH

PROFILE

A professional whose path — from Michelin-starred hospitality to eCommerce to marketing technology — has produced a rare combination of behavioral depth, technical acumen, and communication fluency. A lifelong, self-directed student of human psychology and behavioral research, with a track record of anticipating needs, navigating complexity, and building lasting trust across diverse teams and clients. Thrives where genuine human insight and technical problem-solving intersect, and brings a lifelong growth mindset to every environment — personally, intellectually, and technically.

SKILLS

Technical Skills

HTML / CSS / JavaScript / SQL / Python / VBA

Tools & Platforms

Azure DevOps / Google Analytics / Looker / HubSpot / Smartsheet / Wrike / Google Ads / YouTube Ads / Facebook Ads / Slack / Microsoft Teams

Core Competencies

Customer & Stakeholder Management / Relationship Building & Trust / Platform Adoption & Value Realization / Expansion Opportunity Identification / Cross-Functional Project Leadership / Diplomatic Communication & Team Coordination / API Integration & Custom Systems / Email Campaign Strategy & Automation / UX Research & Design

EDUCATION

Bellevue University

B.S. in Web Development

2026 (expected)

Actively applying coursework in JavaScript and Node.js to real-world projects, including a current UX redesign initiative at Herschend Entertainment.

University of Southern California

MFA in Acting, School of Dramatic Arts

2007–2010

Brenau University

Bachelor of Arts

2000–2004

CONTACT

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Gainesville, GA

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EXPERIENCE

ECOMMERCE SPECIALIST

Herschend Entertainment — Peachtree Corners, GA

September 2023 – Present

- Independently designed and built a VBA/Excel automation that reduced daily workflow triage from 60+ minutes to under one minute, streamlining operations across 3-4 teams and ~20 stakeholders.
- Delivered daily cross-team progress visibility that enabled marketing and web content teams to accurately forecast and schedule page builds, reducing downstream coordination friction.
- Partnered with cross-functional stakeholders to drive utilization of custom eCommerce features, executing campaigns reaching 6M+ users and increasing conversions by over 2%.
- Uncovered new use cases for sales flows and promotions on bespoke HTML/API platform, expanding revenue across eight major properties (including Silver Dollar City and Dollywood).
- Enhanced team productivity workflows with technical optimizations (HTML, VBA, Python) to deliver measurable end-user value.
- Built authentic relationships across diverse teams, aligning on goals and resolving challenges with diplomacy in high-pressure settings.
- Excelled in relating highly technical concepts to non-technical partners (C-Suite, Directors, Managers, All Client Ranges).
- Contributing to UX redesign initiative, identifying platform pain points and advocating for end-user experience improvements.
- Participated in Agile SDLC sprint cycles using Azure DevOps, contributing to backlog management and bug tracking in a two-week sprint cadence.

DIRECTOR OF SALES

Marc Szabo Studios, Inc. — Los Angeles, CA

March 2023 – September 2023

- Cultivated trust-based client relationships, delivering tailored solutions that drove strategy adoption and expanded engagement.
- Pioneered AI automations and optimizations (Google Ads, YouTube, email), maximizing ROI and long-term value.
- Introduced GPT-based workflows to the team, enabling leadership to leverage AI for strategic planning and market research.

UPSCALE HOSPITALITY PROFESSIONAL

Los Angeles, CA

2013 – 2023

Venues include: Four Seasons, Casa del Mar, Innovative Dining Group, SBE Nightlife, and Chef Josiah Citrin's Michelin-starred restaurants

- Delivered white-glove service to high-net-worth clientele — including private events for celebrities, executives, and billionaires — consistently exceeding expectations in zero-margin-for-error environments.
- Developed advanced behavioral literacy in client-facing settings, reading tone, body language, and temperament in real time to anticipate needs and de-escalate tension before it surfaced.
- Applied strategic expectation management across every client interaction, setting clear tones early and maintaining them through resolution — a discipline now central to my professional approach.
- Assessed team strengths and weaknesses in dynamic, high-pressure settings, deploying talent strategically to maximize performance and guest satisfaction.
- Co-managed bar program at a Beverly Hills Italian restaurant, maintaining rigorous quality and consistency standards across a full-service operation.

MARKETING MANAGER

Elliott Wave International — Gainesville, GA

2011 – 2013

- Supported digital marketing initiatives including email campaign strategy and execution for a financial publishing firm.
- Contributed writing and copy editing to The Socionomist, an in-house financial publication.
- Authored a chapter on Depression-era Hollywood for Pioneering Studies in Socionomics by Robert R. Prechter, published by the Socionomics Institute.